

READYSETPDF

User Manual



Version 4.0

A complete guide for people who are new to the program.
Every tool, every panel, and the path from a source file
to a finished PDF.

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1. Welcome

ReadySetPDF is a desktop program for people who prepare print files. You use it to fit pages onto a sheet, crop and rotate, add cut marks, build booklets, merge names onto envelopes, check a file before it goes to press, and watch folders so the same job can run again and again.

This manual is for someone opening version 4.0 for the first time. It walks through the whole window, then every tool. You do not need to know how a press works before you start. Each chapter says what the tool is for, what you will see on the screen, and a simple way to use it.

What this program is for

- Resize a page onto Letter, A4, or a size you name.
- Crop margins, rotate pages, and add cutter marks.
- Lay out many copies on one press sheet (Grid and Monkey).
- Build a saddle-stitched booklet, with creep for paper thickness.
- Place spreadsheet columns on a template for mail merge and stamps.
- Convert color for print or for the screen.
- Preflight a PDF: fonts, pictures, color, bleed, thin lines, and ink.
- Run saved jobs from hot folders, including mail merge.
- Turn scans into searchable PDFs.
- Draw fold guides and export a die-line proof.
- Unlock a PDF you are allowed to open, and save a finished file with optional proof marks and locks.

Two kinds of saved setups

ReadySetPDF uses the word recipe in two places. They are different, and mixing them up is the most common surprise for a new user.

- **Job recipe.** On the Applied Steps stack, Save Recipe stores the steps you built: resize, crop, grid, booklet, color, mail merge, and so on. Automation runs this file.
- **Preflight recipe.** On the Preflight tab, Save Recipe stores a checking profile: which tests matter, how strict they are, and which folders receive a pass, a maybe, or a fail. It does not resize or impose the PDF.

KEEP THIS IN MIND

A job recipe changes the PDF when you save or when a hot folder runs. A preflight recipe reads the PDF and writes a report. It leaves the artwork itself alone.

2. Free, Trial, and Pro

The footer at the bottom right shows your edition. A new installation starts a **30-day trial**. During the trial every tool is unlocked. When the trial ends, the footer reads Free and the core tools stay available.

What you can do for free

Free includes **Resize, Crop, Rotate, Cutter, Unlock, and Folds**. You can also open Preflight and read the report. Free works on **one file at a time**. If a file is already loaded and you add another, ReadySetPDF tells you that Free includes one file at a time. If you pick several files at once, only the first one is added.

What Pro adds

Pro and the trial add **Mail Merge, Color, Automation, OCR, Booklet, Monkey, and Grid**, plus the extra Preflight actions: saving the report, moving files into pass / fail / maybe folders, and the one-click jumps into Color and Page Geometry. Pro can load more than one file and can run folder batches.

Pro tools show a star on the tab, for example Mail Merge/Stamp *. The line above the tabs says the same thing: star means a Pro tool, and you can drag a tab to rearrange it. A locked tool is gray. Clicking it opens the license window.

How to activate

Open **Global Settings** and choose **Activate / check license**, or use the license window that appears when you click a locked tool. Paste the key from your purchase, or an offline key if one was issued for you. **Upgrade / Buy Pro** opens www.readysetpdf.com.

The Account panel tells you the status in a sentence, such as all tools unlocked for 30 days, core tools only, or Pro is active. The footer shortens that to Trial with days left, Free, or Pro.

PREFLIGHT IS A SPECIAL CASE

The Preflight tab itself is open to everyone, with no star. Reading the report is free. The buttons marked with a star on that tab — export, and the jumps to Color and Page Geometry — belong to Pro and the trial.

3. A tour of the window

The title bar reads **ReadySetPDF 4.0 - Professional Prepress**. The header shows the name and the version. Four buttons sit at the top right, from left to right:

- **About** — version, company, website, email, and Check for Hot-Fixes.
- **Global Settings** — license, theme, units, hot-fixes, and custom page sizes.
- **Export Proof Images** — saves a PNG picture of each page in the current preview.
- **Build & Save Final PDF** — the green button. This is how you write the finished file.

Background Engine

Under the header is a navy bar labeled **Background Engine**. It starts collapsed, with a small triangle and the words Idle - Ready for tasks. Click the bar to open it. You will see a line for Pipeline 1, Pipeline 2, and Pipeline 3. When a hot folder is listening or working, the collapsed bar summarizes it, for example Pipeline 1: Listening. Quiet lines such as Idle, Stopped, and Not configured stay off that summary so you can see what is actually busy.

The four work areas

The main window is split into panes you can drag wider or narrower.

- **1. Assets Manager**, on the upper left. Your source files live here.
- **2. Applied Steps Stack**, under the file list. This is the recipe of actions, in order.
- **The tool tabs**, in the center. This is where you set up Resize, Crop, Preflight, and the rest. The center scrolls if the window is short.
- **4. Real-Time Monitor**, on the right. This is the live preview.

Each of those three panels — Assets, Steps, and the Monitor — has a small pop-out control on its title. Pop-out opens that panel in its own window. A Dock button puts it back. Use this when you want the preview on a second

screen, or when you want the file list out of the way.

The footer

The bottom left says System Ready, next to **Report Bug / Feedback**. The bottom right shows the revision and your license, for example Rev 4.0 | Trial · 29 days left.

The tab bar

Hover any tab for a one-line explanation of that tool. Drag a tab to a new place. ReadySetPDF remembers the order. The tools, in the order they first appear, are:

Tab	Edition	In one sentence
Resize	Free	Fit each page onto a target sheet size.
Crop	Free	Trim margins off every page.
Cutter	Free	Add cut marks and finishing marks.
Rotate	Free	Turn selected pages 90, 180, or 270 degrees.
Unlock	Free	Save a copy with password restrictions removed.
Folds	Free	Draw brochure fold guides and export a proof.
Preflight	Read for free	Check the file before it goes to press.
Mail Merge/Stamp	Pro	Place spreadsheet fields on a template.
Color	Pro	Convert to CMYK, RGB, gray, or black and white.
Automation	Pro	Three hot folders, each with its own recipe.
OCR Extract	Pro	Three folders that make searchable PDFs.
Booklet	Pro	Saddle-stitch spreads, with creep.
Monkey	Pro	Fit as many originals as possible on a sheet.
Grid	Pro	A fixed number of rows and columns on a sheet.

4. Your first job

This is the shortest path from a PDF on disk to a new PDF on disk. Later chapters explain each choice. For the first run, follow the steps and leave the extras alone.

- 1 Open ReadySetPDF.
- 2 In Global Settings, under Global Unit of Measurement, choose inches, millimeters, or points. Do this before you type any sizes.
- 3 In Assets Manager, click Add Files and choose one PDF. You can also drop the file onto the list.
- 4 Look at the Real-Time Monitor. You should see the page. The status line says Viewing: Original Baseline.
- 5 Click the Crop tab. Type a small amount in Top, Left, Right, and Bottom if you want to trim the edges. Click Add Crop Step.
- 6 The step appears in Applied Steps. The monitor updates.
- 7 Click Build & Save Final PDF. Leave the default, which merges everything into one PDF. Click Choose Path & Save and pick a new file name.

The original file is still where you found it. ReadySetPDF writes a new file. A successful save says the production layout was generated, and shows the path.

SAVE THE STEPS IF YOU WILL DO THIS AGAIN

Before you close the program, click Save Recipe on the Applied Steps stack. Next time, Load Recipe brings the same steps back. Give the file a name you will recognize, such as Letter crop.json.

5. Assets Manager

Assets Manager is the list of files this job will use. Add Files opens a picker titled Add Files. You can select PDF files and common pictures: PNG, JPG, JPEG, TIF, and TIFF. Dropping files onto the list, the pale area behind it, or the main window does the same thing.

Clear empties the file list and also clears the Applied Steps stack. If you spent time building steps, click Save Recipe before you click Clear.

Click a file name in the list to read its page boxes in the summary under Page Geometry. When more than one file is loaded, the monitor's File buttons move between them, unless Preview Merged is on.

One file or many

Trial and Pro can load many files. Free keeps a single file. Pictures are welcome: a PNG or a TIFF is treated as a one-page source, which is useful for a scan or a logo sheet.

If you drop a file that is still copying, including a file from a network folder, ReadySetPDF waits until the copy settles and then opens it. If it cannot open the path, a message names the file.

Page Geometry

At the bottom of Assets Manager is **Page Geometry / Box Settings**. Click the heading to open it. The summary shows the first page of the selected file in your current unit. A typical line names Media, Crop, and Trim. A missing box is shown as a dash. With no file loaded, the line says Load a file to read Media / Crop / Trim.

Three choices control what happens when a file comes in. The choice is saved with your settings and with a job recipe, and it applies to the preview, to Build & Save, and to hot-folder runs.

- **Do nothing (keep original boxes).** The PDF's boxes stay as they were written. The preview still lines the page up so an offset box does not look clipped.
- **Set CropBox to match TrimBox.** Viewers hide the bleed and marks, and the full media box is still in the file.
- **Remove extra margins / white space.** The page is clipped to the trim box.

The help line under the choices says the same thing in shorter words: Keep leaves boxes alone, CropBox equals TrimBox hides bleed without deleting it, and Remove extra margins clips the page to the trim box.

A PDF can carry several boxes. **Media** is the whole page, including any extra. **Crop** is what many viewers display. **Trim** is the finished cut size. **Bleed** is the extra artwork past the cut, so a slight mis-cut does not show white paper. **Art** is another box some files include. If Trim or Art is missing, ReadySetPDF falls back to Crop, then to Media.

OPEN THIS PANEL WHEN A PREVIEW LOOKS SHIFTED

Some imposed files store the page with an origin that is not zero. Page Geometry and the preview line that page up so the artwork sits in the window the way you expect.

6. Applied Steps

The stack is the job, from top to bottom. ReadySetPDF runs the steps in that order. A crop followed by a resize is different from a resize followed by a crop.

How a step gets onto the stack

Set up a tool in the center, then click its green Add button. The label matches the tool: Add Resize Step, Add Crop Step, Add Monkey Imposition, Add Grid Imposition, Add Booklet Step, Add Cutter Marks, Add Rotation Step, Add Standard Color Conversion, or Add to Stack on Mail Merge.

The new step lands just after the step you have selected. If the last step is selected, or the stack was empty, the new step goes at the bottom. You need at least one file loaded. If the list is empty, the message is Load source PDF documents first.

Selecting, overwriting, and reordering

Click a step. That tool's tab opens and the boxes fill with the values from that step. The monitor shows the job **up through the step you clicked**. The status line says Viewing Step State Slice, followed by the step's name. Build & Save uses that same stopping point. To include every step in the finished PDF, click the last step, or click empty space so that no earlier step is the stopping point.

Overwrite saved step is the mint button on the tool. It is available only when the selected stack step is the same kind of step as the tab you are on. It replaces that step with the numbers now on the screen. If you click it at the wrong time, the message is Select a matching step in the stack first. Mail Merge uses shorter labels: Overwrite and Add to Stack.

If the tab you are looking at is not part of the preview, the monitor says that pane is not in this preview, and tells you to add it or click that step. That keeps a Cutter setup from painting marks onto the page while you meant to be looking at Rotate or Grid.

- **Move Up** and **Move Down** change the order.
- **Remove** deletes the selected step.
- **Reset** clears the whole stack and leaves your files in Assets Manager.
- **Save Recipe** writes the stack, your unit, and the Page Geometry choice to a file you name.
- **Load Recipe** brings a saved stack back.

Save Recipe does nothing if the stack is empty, and it does not show an error. After a real save you get Recipe saved successfully. Load Recipe expects that same kind of file. Older recipes that are only a list of steps still open.

What the stack lines look like

Each line is a short description: a crop with its four edges, a resize with the preset name, a color line with the mode and DPI, a mail-merge line with the spreadsheet name, and so on. You do not edit the words. You click the line, change the tool, and overwrite, or you add a new step.

7. The Real-Time Monitor

The monitor is the picture of the job at the step you have selected. Use it before you trust a save.

Moving through files and pages

- **File** and the arrows step through the files in Assets Manager. The label reads File: 1 / 3, or File: 0 / 0 when nothing is loaded, or File: ALL (Merged) when everything is combined.

- **Page** and the arrows move inside the current preview. The mouse wheel over the preview also changes pages in several tools.
- **Preview Merged** combines every loaded file into one preview. Turn it off to inspect a single file. While it is on, the file arrows rest, because there is only one combined view.

Zoom and rulers

Zoom starts at **1.0x (Fit Width)**, so the page fills the width of the pane and you scroll for a tall sheet. The other choices are Fit Height, 1.5x Zoom, 2.0x High Zoom, and 3.0x Max Detail.

Show Rulers is on when you first open the program. Ticks follow your unit: inches down to sixteenths when you are zoomed in, millimeters at 1, 5, and 10, and points at 6, 18, and 72. Hover the page and a readout shows the distance from the **left** edge and the **top** edge. In inches you also see a fraction, such as 1 1/2. Hairlines track the cursor to both rulers. The small label in the corner of the rulers shows in, mm, or pt.

Which tools update live

Grid, Monkey, Booklet, Cutter, and Rotate redraw the preview while you edit, even before you add the step, when the stack does not already contain that step. Resize, Crop, and Color update the preview when you are adjusting a matching step at the end of the stack. Opening Color does not turn the preview gray by itself. Folds draws its guides on the monitor and is explained in its own chapter. Mail Merge has its own template picture, which stays on the same page as the monitor.

A booklet with creep shows an extra note on the cover: the cover has 0 creep, and you should page forward to see the inner sheets.

Proof pictures

Export Proof Images saves a PNG of every page in the current preview into a folder you choose. The files are named ReadySetPDF_Proof_Spread_1.png and so on. These are pictures for a customer or for your own notes. They are not the print PDF. If the preview is empty, the button has nothing to export.

8. Units, themes, and page sizes

Open **Global Settings**. Two tabs are inside: Preferences and Custom Page Sizes.

Preferences

- **Account** shows your status, the free tool list, the Pro tool list, Activate / check license, and Upgrade / Buy Pro.
- **Application Theme** offers Tech Theme (Default), Ink Wash, California Beaches, and Cobalt Sky. Choosing one saves it and redraws the window.
- **Global Unit of Measurement** is Inches (in), Millimeters (mm), or Points (pt). The note under the choices says this unit applies across the software.
- **Updates** has Check for Hot-Fixes and a status line. The same button is in About.

Choose the unit **before** you type widths and heights. A number you already typed stays on screen as the same digits, and those digits are then read in the new unit. Mail-merge X, Y, width, and height boxes are the exception: they convert when you switch. The Page Geometry readout always follows the unit you pick.

You may type decimals with a period or a comma. 8.5 and 8,5 are the same amount. Do not type a thousands separator.

Custom Page Sizes

A custom size is a name plus a width and a height, in the current unit. Enter the size as **portrait**: the short side, then the long side. Landscape is a checkbox on the tool that uses the size, not part of the preset itself.

Type a name, width, and height, then Save Custom Preset. The list shows the name and the two numbers. Edit loads the selected size back into the boxes. Up and Down reorder the list. Delete removes one. Saved sizes appear in the preset menus on Resize, Grid, Monkey, Booklet, and Folds, next to the built-in names.

If the name, width, or height is blank, you are asked to enter all three. If a side is not a number, you are asked to use a comma or a period for the decimal.

Built-in sizes you will see

Resize offers Letter, Legal, Tabloid, and A4, plus your custom names. Grid and Monkey offer 12x18, 13x19, Letter, and Tabloid. Booklet offers Tabloid (11x17) and Letter (8.5x11). Folds offers Letter, Legal, Tabloid, A4, and Use current PDF. Any tool can also take a width and height you type by hand.

9. Resize

Resize fits each page onto a target sheet. Use it when the source is the wrong trim, and use it before an imposition when the incoming page size is not the size you want to step and repeat.

The panel is **Target Fixed Paper Size Settings**. Pick a preset or type Width and Height. **Force Landscape Orientation Layout** swaps the sheet to landscape. **Stretch content layer to fit bounding box**, when checked, ignores the aspect ratio and stretches the page to the box. Leave it off when circles must stay circles.

Click **Add Resize Step**. To change a resize that is already in the stack, select that line and click **Overwrite saved step**.

EXAMPLE

A poster PDF is 11 by 17 inches and the shop wants Letter. Choose the Letter preset, leave stretch off, add the step, and confirm in the monitor that the artwork sits inside the Letter page.

10. Crop

Crop trims margins off every page. Amounts are in your global unit. The four boxes are Top, Left, Right, and Bottom, and they start at 0. Uneven crops are normal: a larger left value than right value simply takes more from the left.

Crop removes the discarded margin from the page. It does not merely hide it. That matters when a file already has crop marks and you want to cut them away before you scale or impose. After a real crop, a later resize sees the trimmed page.

Add the step with **Add Crop Step**. Select that stack line later if you need to change the four numbers and overwrite.

EXAMPLE

A letter PDF has a quarter inch of unwanted white on every side. Set all four boxes to 0.25 while the unit is inches, add the crop, and check the rulers.

11. Rotate

Rotate turns pages and, at 90 and 270 degrees, swaps the page width and height. The page is not scaled back into the old shape. A landscape letter that you rotate 90 degrees becomes a portrait letter.

The box starts at 90 degrees. **Pages Selector Filter** starts at all. Buttons fill that box for you:

- **All** sets all.
- **Odd / Front** sets odd. In a duplex pair, odd pages are the fronts.
- **Even / Back** sets even.

You can also type a list. Pages are numbered from 1. Use commas and dashes, such as 1,3,5 or 2-4. The words odd, front, even, and back are accepted as well.

Add the step with **Add Rotation Step**. The preview updates while you edit.

12. Cutter

Cutter draws finishing marks for a cutter or a collator. It does not rearrange pages. Add it after the imposition when you want marks on the imposed sheet, or add it on its own when the file is already the right size.

Registration marks

Size starts at 0.13 and thickness at 0.03, in the current unit. Placement is **Inside** or **Outside** the media box. Margins start at 0. Mark color is Black, Grey, or White. The Pages box and the All / Odd / Front / Even / Back buttons work the same way as Rotate, so you can mark only fronts or only backs.

Finishing marks

Draw L cut marks in all four corners starts on. **Extra mark** can be None, Round Dots, Registration Cross, or Registration L. Round Dots sit in the corners. The cross and the extra L use the **Corner** you pick: Top Left, Top Right, Bottom Left, or Bottom Right. The help text on the panel describes those extra marks.

Remove artwork (create a cut-marks only file) leaves the marks and drops the artwork. Use that when a finishing device wants a marks overlay and the artwork is imposed somewhere else.

Click **Add Cutter Marks**. Gap and color notes for Grid, Monkey, and Booklet are in those chapters. Cutter is the tool for marks on a page you are not imposing.

13. Unlock

Unlock saves a working copy of a PDF you are allowed to open, with the security restrictions removed. It is a standalone tool. It does not add a step to the stack, and it does not use the files in Assets Manager unless you pick that same file here.

- 1 Click Select PDF and choose the file.
- 2 If the file asks for a password to open, type it in Password (If any). If the file opens without a password, leave the box blank.
- 3 Click Strip Security & Save Unlocked Copy.
- 4 Choose a new name. The suggested name is Unlocked_Output.pdf.

A missing file produces Please select a target PDF file first. A wrong password produces Invalid password provided for this encrypted file. A success message says the restrictions were cleared and shows where the

copy was saved.

USE THIS ONLY ON FILES YOU ARE ALLOWED TO OPEN

Unlock is for your own files and for files a customer asked you to prepare. It is not a way around someone else's password.

14. Folds

Folds is a visual layout tool for brochures. The banner on the tab says it is a fold guide, and that the export is a die-line proof, not a production PDF. The original artwork is unchanged. Nothing from this tab is added to Applied Steps.

Fold types

The list starts on Tri-fold Brochure. The types are:

- **Single (half) Fold** — two equal panels.
- **Z Fold** — three equal panels that fold into a Z.
- **Single Gate Fold** — left and right flaps fold over a center.
- **Roll (Barrel) Fold** — the outside two panels are the largest, and the piece rolls in.
- **Half Fold & Tri Fold** — fold in half, then tri-fold.
- **Tri-fold Brochure** — three panels, with the right panel slightly smaller so it tucks in.
- **Double Parallel** — half, then half again, with the last panels slightly smaller.
- **Double Gate Fold** — a gate fold, then a fold at the center.
- **Right Angle (French) Fold** — fold in half, then in half the other way.
- **Accordion (M) Fold** — three zigzag folds.

Size, bleed, and direction

Finished flat size is the trim of the flat sheet. Presets include Letter, and you can turn on **Match loaded PDF page size** or pick **Use current PDF**. **Landscape (swap width / height)** starts on, because many brochures are designed landscape. **Bleed, Each side** starts at 0.125 in the current unit. **Artwork already includes this bleed** starts on, so the guides treat the page as trim plus bleed.

Fold direction is either along the width, which draws vertical fold lines, or along the height, which draws horizontal fold lines. A live summary under the controls describes the panels.

What you see, and what you export

On the monitor, green dashed lines are the folds, cyan is the trim, and magenta is the bleed. With no file loaded, the monitor can still show the guide sheet. The status line says Viewing: Fold die-line guide.

Export Die-Line Proof asks you to save a one-page PDF of those guides: trim, bleed, fold marks, and panel labels. The footer of that action reminds you that the original PDF is unchanged. The success message says the file is fold guides only, not a production file.

15. Color

Color is a Pro tool. It converts the pages to a color space you choose, at a resolution you choose. The change becomes part of the stack. The finished pixels are written when you Build & Save, or when a hot folder runs that recipe.

Modes

- **Keep Original Document Colors** leaves the color alone.
- **Grayscale (256 Levels)** is the starting choice.
- **Black & White (High Contrast)** is a stark black-and-white conversion.
- **CMYK (Commercial Print)** is the usual choice for a press.
- **RGB (Digital/Web)** is the usual choice for a screen.

Target DPI is 300, 400, 600, or 1200. It starts at 300. A higher number keeps more detail and makes a larger file.

Quick Add: Convert to CMYK switches the mode to CMYK and adds the step in one click. **Add Standard Color Conversion** adds whatever mode and DPI are on screen. The stack line reads Color, the mode, and the DPI.

Opening the Color tab does not convert the preview by itself. Add the step, or select an existing color step and overwrite it, and the monitor follows.

WHEN PREFLIGHT COMPLAINS ABOUT RGB

On a Pro or trial license, Preflight's Open Color (RGB fix) jumps here. Choose CMYK, add the step, and run Preflight again after you save if you want the report to see the converted file.

16. Grid

Grid is a Pro tool. It places a fixed number of rows and columns on a press sheet. Use it for business cards, postcards, labels, and any job where you already know you want 2 columns and 4 rows, rather than "as many as will fit."

Paper and page order

Paper Size starts at 12 by 18. Presets include 12x18, 13x19, Letter, and Tabloid, plus your custom sizes. Landscape swaps the sheet.

Page Order is **Sequential** or **Step and Repeat**. Sequential fills the sheet with different pages from the source. Step and Repeat fills the sheet with copies of the same page. **Repeat each page** starts at 1. Set it higher when each artwork should appear more than once before the next artwork starts.

Double sided builds a back. In a pair, page 1 is the front and page 2 is the back. Step and Repeat fills a sheet with the front, then a mirrored sheet with the back. Sequential fills the front with the odd pages and the next sheet with their backs. **Long edge** reverses columns, which is the usual book flip. **Short edge** reverses rows, which is the usual calendar flip. The edge buttons stay quiet until Double sided is on. On a landscape sheet, long-edge tumble follows the long side of that sheet.

How many, and whether to scale

Columns and Rows start at 2 and 2. **Autoscale graphic to fit cell** starts **off**. Leave it off when the PDF is already the right size: a 106 mm card stays 106 mm. When Autoscale is on, the artwork scales up or down to fill the cell, and the white-space numbers change the cell rather than the artwork's own size. **Maintain aspect ratio** starts on and only matters while Autoscale is on. It keeps the artwork from stretching.

White space and the 3 by 3 anchor

A pad of nine positions sits beside the margins. The selected cell shows a dot. Margins are measured from that anchor, not always from the top-left of the sheet. The center cell is the same idea as centering the output on the page. With Double sided on, the back sheet mirrors the anchor to match the flip edge: left and right swap on a long-edge portrait flip, and top and bottom swap on a short-edge flip.

Margins start at 0. Gutters start at 0.25 and 0.25. Gutters are the gaps between the copies. The help under the boxes explains the horizontal and vertical gutter in your unit.

Source trim, when the PDF already has bleed

This block is shared with Monkey and Booklet. Turn on **PDF already includes bleed** and type the **finished trim** width and height. The boxes stay disabled until that box is checked. Layout then steps by the finished trim. **Gutter 0 means the trims touch.** The bleed hangs into the gutter, half on each side of the cut, and it can overlap a neighbor when the gutter is smaller than the bleed on both sides. You do not type a negative gutter to “cancel” bleed. Crop marks sit on the trim, not on the outer bleed edge. Leave the trim width and height blank to use the PDF’s own trim box when that box is smaller than the page.

Printer’s marks

Draw crop marks (at trim when bleed is set) starts on. **Gap distance** starts at 0.125. A positive gap holds the mark off the trim. A negative gap pulls the mark into the live area. **Line thickness** starts at 0.007. Color is Black, Grey, or White.

Click **Add Grid Imposition**. The preview updates while you type, which is the right way to see whether a 3 mm gutter is enough for the bleed.

A NUMBERS EXAMPLE

The artwork is 106 by 426 mm, with a 100 by 420 mm trim and 3 mm of bleed. Unit is millimeters. Autoscale is off. Three columns on a sheet, gutter 0. The trims touch. The bleed hangs into the gutter. The card is not squeezed to fit.

17. Monkey

Monkey is a Pro tool. It fits **as many originals as possible** onto the sheet. You do not type a column count. Use Grid when you want an exact 3 by 2. Use Monkey when you want the sheet filled as tightly as the margins and gutters allow.

Paper Size starts as a custom 9.5 by 12, with the same presets as Grid: 12x18, 13x19, Letter, and Tabloid. Page order, Double sided, Short edge, Long edge, and Repeat each page work the same way as Grid.

Layout (Auto Max-Fit) is Left-to-Right or Right-to-Left. White space has margins and gutters, both starting at 0, and **Center output on page**, which starts on. Monkey does not use the 3 by 3 pad. Centering is the checkbox.

Source Trim and Printer’s Marks match Grid, including crop marks that start on, a gap of 0.125, and a thickness of 0.007. The marks caption here is Draw crop marks (at trim when bleed is set).

Click **Add Monkey Imposition** and read the monitor. If the count of copies looks wrong, check Autoscale’s cousin here: Monkey always hunts for a fit, so a large gutter or a large margin reduces how many copies land on the sheet. A source that already includes bleed should have Source Trim filled in, or the program will treat the outer bleed as the piece size and fit fewer copies.

18. Booklet

Booklet is a Pro tool. It imposes saddle-stitch spreads: the page order a stapler in the center needs, so that page 1 faces the last page on the outside sheet.

The note at the top says the source page count must be divisible by 4. A 6-page file needs two blank pages before it will impose cleanly. A 7-sheet booklet is 28 pages. If you are short, use **Pad Document**.

Inserting blank pages

Insert blank page at can be End of Document, Beginning of Document, or After Page #. The page-number box starts at 1 and is only used for After Page #. **Insert Blank Page** adds its own stack step, separate from Add Booklet Step. You can insert more than one blank by clicking it again. Then add the booklet step after the blanks in the stack, so the blanks exist before the imposition runs.

Sheet, white space, and creep

Paper Size starts at 18 by 12, which is a landscape tabloid-style sheet, with presets for Tabloid (11x17) and Letter (8.5x11). Landscape is available if you need to swap it.

White space uses the same 3 by 3 anchor as Grid. Here the anchor places the **pair of facing pages**. Margins start at 0. **Center Gutter** is the gap at the spine between the two pages on the sheet, and it starts at 0.

Creep / sheet is the thickness of one sheet of paper. It starts at 0. The cover shifts by nothing. Each sheet inward adds that thickness again. **Creep Outward** moves pages toward the spine. **Creep Inward** opens the gutter. The monitor's page 1 is the cover, so creep looks like zero there. Page forward to an inner sheet to see the shift. If you set a creep and the preview is still on the cover, ReadySetPDF will offer the inner sheets when it can.

Bleed and marks

Source Trim works the same way as Grid. With **PDF already includes bleed** on, the facing pages pack on the finished size, so bleed does not look like extra gutter. **Draw crop marks at the source trim** starts **off** for booklets. Turn it on when you want marks. Gap, thickness, and color match the other imposition tools.

Click **Add Booklet Step**.

A CREEP EXAMPLE

Seven sheets, and the paper is 0.12 mm thick. Set the unit to millimeters, set Creep / sheet to 0.12, and page forward from the cover. The inner sheet moves by several times 0.12 mm. The cover stays put.

19. Mail Merge and stamps

Mail Merge/Stamp is a Pro tool. It is a layout window, not a form of coordinates you have to invent. You load a template PDF (the envelope, postcard, or ticket), load a spreadsheet, click a column, and click the template to drop that field. Build & Save, or a hot folder, repeats the template once for every data row.

The spreadsheet

Section 1. **Spreadsheet / Record Count** has Browse and Clear. Browse accepts CSV, Excel (.xlsx), and LibreOffice ODS. The first row is the header row. Those headers become tags such as <<Name>>.

If **no file, generate** starts at 1 record. Use that when you are placing a serial number and you do not have a spreadsheet yet. The italic note on the row says ODS, XLSX, and CSV are supported, and that a footer count such as 108 rows is the live data, not an error.

Blank rows, and rows that have no data in the columns you placed, are skipped. A 2-page postcard and 10 filled rows produce 20 pages.

Field style

Section **2. Field Style** applies to the next tag you place, and to the field you have selected.

- **Column** uses the header chosen in the dropdown.
- **Static / [NUM]** uses the text you type. The sample text is Ticket-[NUM]. **Start** is 1 and **Zeros** is 3, so the first record becomes Ticket-001, then Ticket-002.
- The type list is **Text**, **QR Code**, and **HTML**. Text places the words. QR Code turns those words into a scannable square. HTML places the text in the box as well; for ordinary names and addresses, choose Text.
- **Address Block** opens the address window described below.
- Font is any font installed on the computer. Size starts at 12. Alignment is Left, Center, or Right. The color box starts at #000000, which is black. You can type another web color, such as #003366.
- **B**, **I**, and **U** are bold, italic, and underline.
- **X**, **Y**, **W**, **H** are the position and the box size, in the current unit. In inches they start near 0.5, 0.5, 2.0, and 0.5. Switching units converts these four numbers.
- **Auto-shrink** starts on. If a line is longer than the box, the type shrinks so it still fits. That is what lets 12 point type sit in a 6 mm window.

Placing fields

The left sidebar is **Field Tags**. The instruction there says: click a column tag to arm it, then click the template to place it. Click a placed box to select it. Selecting does not add another copy. Ctrl+Z undoes.

- 1 Load the envelope or card with Add Files so the monitor and the template show it.
- 2 Browse to the spreadsheet. Tags appear. If there are no columns yet, the sidebar says so.
- 3 Click a tag. The cursor becomes a crosshair and the hint says you are placing that tag.
- 4 Click the template. A green box appears. Drag it to move it. You may park it past the trim, into the bleed.
- 5 Click the box again when you want to change its font, size, or color. The style section follows the selected field.
- 6 Right-click a box, press Delete, or click the X to remove it. Ctrl+Z brings it back. The undo list holds a generous run of recent edits.
- 7 The **Placed fields** list under the tags is another way to select. Click a row.

The template caption says it is the same page as the Real-Time Monitor. Page arrows and the wheel move both. A field you place on page 2 stays on page 2 of every merged copy. Double-click an address block to edit its columns. The empty template says to load a PDF or an image in Assets Manager.

Address Block

Click **Address Block** in the sidebar, or the Address Block button in the style section. You need a spreadsheet first. The window is titled Address Block, with the heading Build one address object.

Field 1 through **Field 4** are four lines. Each dropdown is a column from the spreadsheet. Empty choices are skipped, so a missing company line does not leave a blank gap. **City / ZIP** is three dropdowns on one line: city, state or region, and postal code. They print as City, ST, then the postal code. The labels are not stuck to American city names. A Dutch postcode and woonplaats pair works if you point the dropdowns at those columns.

A sample of the first data row is drawn in the window. If nothing is chosen, it says empty, pick columns above. **Use This Block** places the object. **Update Block** appears when you are editing an existing one. The box grows if it is too small for an address: in inches it moves toward about 3.25 wide and 1.25 tall.

ReadySetPDF guesses Name, Address, City, State, and ZIP when those headers exist. You can change any dropdown.

Preview, then add the step

Preview opens **VDP Merge Preview (low-res)**. Page arrows move through output pages. Record arrows jump by a whole record. The caption shows the record number, the template page, and the output page. Blank rows are skipped. The window shows up to 40 records and tells you when more exist. Close Preview returns you to the tab.

Add to Stack stores the layout, including the path to the spreadsheet and the template. That stored template is what a hot folder uses later, so the hot folder only needs the spreadsheet. If you click Build & Save while fields are placed but the step is not on the stack, ReadySetPDF asks whether it should add the step for you. The question mentions the green add button. Choose yes to include the merge, or no to go back.

A SIMPLE ENVELOPE

Add the envelope PDF. Browse the mailing list. Click Address Block, accept the guessed columns, and click Use This Block. Drag the block into the window. Click Preview. Then Add to Stack, and Build & Save.

20. Preflight

Preflight reads a PDF and writes a report. It checks the things a print shop looks at before a plate or a digital press: fonts, picture sharpness, color, page boxes, bleed, thin strokes, transparency, overprint, and ink coverage. **The report does not change the PDF.** Fixing a problem means adding a step, adjusting Page Geometry, or going back to the design file, and then running the check again.

The tab note says: Free can run and read the report. Pro and the trial add JSON, a PDF of the report, routing, and one-click jumps to the fix tools.

A first run

- 1 Load one or more PDFs.
- 2 Open Preflight. The profile starts on Standard Digital Press.
- 3 Leave Manual execution checked.
- 4 Leave the file name pattern at *.pdf unless you only want some of the files.
- 5 Click Run Preflight Analysis.
- 6 Read the report from the title at the top down to the line END OF REPORT.

If Manual execution is off, ReadySetPDF tells you to turn it on under Triggers. If no loaded file matches the pattern, it tells you none match. If some names match and some do not, the matching files are checked as they are on disk, and a routing note says the applied steps were not imposed onto the group. When every loaded file matches, the check includes the steps in the stack, up through the step you have selected, so you can preflight the imposed result.

What the report contains

The title is READYSETPDF PREFLIGHT REPORT. Under it you get a page count, a count of findings, and, when a profile is active, a line such as Recipe: Standard Digital Press · Result: FAIL. The result is PASS, MAYBE, or FAIL. FAIL means at least one check set to Error failed. MAYBE means nothing failed, but at least one Warning fired. PASS means neither.

- Each page lists its size and its Media, Crop, Trim, and Bleed boxes, in your unit. Bleed is OK, SHORT, or MISSING.
- **Color space** reports RGB, CMYK, gray, spot colors, and the color spaces it saw. RGB points you at the Color tab when that check is a warning or an error.
- **Image resolution** lists pictures under your minimum DPI.
- **Image inventory** lists pictures with pixel size, approximate PPI, color, and compression. Long lists stop after 40 and say how many more exist.
- **Fonts** names each font and whether it is embedded. A font that is not embedded can substitute on another computer.
- **Line weights** lists strokes thinner than your hairline limit.
- **Transparency / overprint** notes soft masks, blend modes, and overprint.
- **Total area coverage** estimates the heaviest ink on CMYK pictures it can read. Some pictures are skipped when the data cannot be read. Coverage is a percentage. Many shops worry above 300 percent.
- **Suggested next steps** appears when ReadySetPDF has a plain-language hint, such as converting RGB or fixing bleed.
- **Routing** appears after a run that has notes: which files were skipped, where a copy was moved, or that a Pro action was left for a Pro license.

The nine checks

Each check has a severity: **Error (Fail)**, **Warning (Maybe)**, or **Ignore**. Error pushes the file to Fail. Warning pushes it to Maybe, unless an error is also present. Ignore leaves that issue out of the verdict. Some checks also have a number.

Check	What you are asking	A typical starting number
Minimum image DPI	How sharp pictures must be.	300, as an error
Font embedding	Whether fonts must be embedded.	Error, no number
Box inspection / bleed (in)	How much bleed, in inches, must exist past the trim.	0.125, as a warning
Color space (RGB)	Whether RGB should be flagged.	Warning
Hairline stroke (pt)	The thinnest stroke you will accept, in points.	0.25
Max CMYK TAC %	The heaviest ink coverage you will accept.	300
Transparency / soft mask	Whether transparency should be flagged.	Warning
Overprint	Whether overprint should be flagged.	Ignore on the digital profile
JPEG 2000 compression	Whether that picture compression should be flagged.	Warning

Hairlines are collected from strokes already under a quarter of a point. Setting the hairline number higher than 0.25 does not reveal strokes the check never collected. Leave it at 0.25, or lower it if you only care about even thinner lines.

The three profiles that ship with the program

The first time you open Preflight, three profiles are ready. You can change them and save, or you can add your own name in the profile box and save a new one.

Profile	Which files	How strict
Standard Digital Press	*.pdf, by hand and from a hot folder	300 DPI and embedded fonts are errors. Bleed, RGB, hairlines, ink, transparency, and JPEG 2000 are warnings. Overprint is ignored.
Commercial Sheetfed	Names ending in _print.pdf, by hand and from a hot folder	Bleed, RGB, hairlines, and ink are errors too. Overprint is a warning. Transparency and JPEG 2000 stay warnings.
Soft Proof	Names containing PROOF, by hand only	150 DPI and fonts are warnings. Bleed, color, hairlines, ink, transparency, overprint, and JPEG 2000 are ignored.

The recipe editor

The top of the tab is **Recipe / Profile**. The profile name is a dropdown you can also type in.

- **Save Recipe** stores the profile. You are told the name that was saved.
- **Delete Recipe** asks you to confirm. If you delete the last one, the three built-in profiles come back.
- **Criteria & thresholds** is the grid of nine checks.
- **Destination routing** is three folders: Pass, Fail (error), and Maybe (warning). Browse picks a folder. Leave them blank if you only want to read the report.
- **File name pattern** uses stars as wildcards. *.pdf is every PDF. *_print.pdf is names that end in _print.pdf. *PROOF*.pdf is names that contain PROOF. Matching ignores capital letters.
- **Manual execution** lets Run Preflight Analysis use this profile.
- **Hot-folder watchdog** lets Automation run this profile on a file it just wrote, when the output name matches.
- **API / external dispatch** lets another program on your side ask this profile to run. Leave it off until that is set up for you.
- **Generate JSON report** writes preflight_report.json into the pass, fail, or maybe folder. It starts on.
- **Email notification hook** writes a text note in that folder so another program can send mail. ReadySetPDF does not send the email itself. The note says no mail server is configured. It starts off.
- **Move original file** moves the PDF into the folder that matches the verdict. It starts off. If the folder for that verdict is blank, the report says the move was skipped.

On a Free license the report can still say that routing, JSON export, and email hooks are part of Pro. The files stay where they are.

Pro actions on the report

- **Export JSON** saves the last report as a data file. Run the analysis first. The suggested name is preflight_report.json.
- **Export PDF Report** saves a printable copy of the report. The suggested name is preflight_report.pdf. The PDF is the report, not a repaired artwork file.
- **Open Color (RGB fix)** switches to the Color tab.
- **Open Page Geometry** opens the box settings in Assets Manager and tells you that Crop, Trim, and Bleed are adjusted there.

Those four buttons are gray on a Free license. Clicking one opens the license window.

A SHOP ROUTINE

Keep Standard Digital Press for everyday files. Duplicate the idea of Commercial Sheetfed for work that must fail closed: pattern *_print.pdf, and errors on bleed and RGB. Use Soft Proof when a customer file has PROOF in the name and you only want a light look at resolution and fonts.

21. Automation

Automation is a Pro tool. It is three hot folders. A hot folder is a folder ReadySetPDF watches. You drop a file in, and the job recipe you attached to that pipeline runs. You can run the pipelines once, or you can leave them listening while you do other work.

The introduction on the tab says it directly: three hot folders, each with its own input, output, and recipe, and one watcher that runs every pipeline you have filled in.

Setting up a pipeline

Pipelines are tabs: Pipeline 1, Pipeline 2, and Pipeline 3. Each one has:

- **Input Folder** — where you drop work.
- **Output Folder** — where the finished PDF is written.
- **Recipe (.json)** — a job recipe from Save Recipe on the Applied Steps stack.

Browse fills each box. A pipeline with any of the three missing is not ready. If you start a run with nothing ready, the message is Set Input, Output, and Recipe on at least one pipeline.

Run once, or watch

Run Configured Pipelines Once processes the files that are already in the input folders, then stops. **Start Hot Folder Watch** keeps listening. The button becomes **Stop Hot Folder Watch**. Each pipeline line shows Idle, Listening, Processing, Stopped, or Not configured. The Background Engine bar at the top of the window shows the same activity, one line per pipeline when you expand it.

If a batch is already running, you are asked to wait. On a Free license the message is Folder batch processing is part of Pro.

What happens to each file

PDFs and pictures (PNG, JPG, JPEG, TIF, TIFF) are jobs. The finished file is named Processed_ plus the original name, in the output folder. The original moves into a folder called Processed_Originals inside the input folder, so the watcher does not pick the same file up again.

Spreadsheets are special. If the job recipe contains a mail-merge step, and that step remembers the envelope or card, a CSV, XLSX, or ODS dropped in the input folder is merged and saved as Processed_ plus the spreadsheet name. If a spreadsheet arrives and the recipe has no stored template, a message titled VDP hot folder tells you to add the merge from a loaded envelope, save the recipe, and drop the spreadsheet again.

Preflight after a hot folder

When a pipeline finishes a PDF, ReadySetPDF can run your active preflight profile on that new file. Two things must be true: the profile's **Hot-folder watchdog** box is on, and the new file's name matches the profile's pattern. Hot-folder names look like Processed_card_print.pdf, so a pattern of *_print.pdf matches a source that was already named card_print.pdf, and a pattern of *.pdf matches every output.

The hot folder uses the profile you last saved and marked active. The on-screen Preflight tab can show unsaved edits. Save the profile if you want the watcher to use them. Routing, JSON, and the email note follow the same

Pro rules as a manual run.

THREE DESKS, ONE PROGRAM

Pipeline 1 can be business cards, Pipeline 2 can be envelopes, and Pipeline 3 can be a booklet. Each has its own recipe. Expand Background Engine if you want to see which one is working.

22. OCR

OCR Extract is a Pro tool. It watches up to three folders. You drop a scan in, and ReadySetPDF writes a **searchable PDF** at the original page size. The words become something you can search and copy, and the page still looks like the scan.

This is separate from the imposition stack. There is no Add Step button here. The work happens in the folders.

Each pipeline

- **Watch Folder** and **Output Folder**.
- **File Naming** is a prefix, the original name, a suffix, and .pdf. The prefix starts as Searchable_OCR_. A scan called invoice.tif becomes Searchable_OCR_invoice.pdf unless you change the prefix or add a suffix.
- **Language** is eng, spa, fra, or deu: English, Spanish, French, or German. It starts on eng.
- **After Processing** is Do nothing, Open output folder, or Attach newly processed files to email.

Accepted drops are PDF, PNG, JPG, JPEG, TIF, and TIFF. The original moves to Processed_Originals inside the watch folder.

Email drafts

Choose **Attach newly processed files to email** and an **Email Template** opens. **Distribution List** is a name you can save with **Save List** and pick again later. **Recipients** is a comma-separated list of addresses. **Message body** can include {date}, which becomes today's date. The sample body says the searchable PDFs are attached to this draft.

ReadySetPDF opens a draft message in your mail program. It does not send the message. You read it, and you send it if it looks right.

Starting and stopping

Start OCR Hot Folders listens to every pipeline that has both folders set. The button becomes **Stop OCR Hot Folders**. Status lines match Automation: Idle, Listening, Processing, Stopped, or Not configured. A **Processing Log** lists what happened.

If the folders are missing, you are asked to set the watch folder and the output folder on at least one pipeline. On a Free license the message is OCR hot folders are part of Pro. If the text-reading program is not installed, the message says the Tesseract OCR engine was not found. OCR needs that program on the computer. Ask the person who set up the PC, or install Tesseract, and try again.

23. Building and saving the PDF

Build & Save Final PDF is the green button at the top right. It runs the stack and writes a new file. Your source files stay where they are.

If Assets Manager is empty, the message is No input files loaded. If you placed mail-merge fields and forgot to add the step, you are offered the chance to add it before the export continues.

The window is titled **Final Production Export**, with the heading Final Output Options. The save uses the steps up through the stack line you have selected. Click the last step when you want the entire stack.

File handling

- **Merge all assets into a single PDF** is the default. The suggested name starts from the first file and ends in _readysetpdf.pdf.
- **Export as individual PDFs** writes one result per source file into a folder you choose. **Append Suffix** appears only for this choice. It starts as _readysetpdf, so card.pdf becomes card_readysetpdf.pdf.

File size

Two boxes start on:

- **Maximum Stream Deflation & Font Deduplication** makes the file smaller by packing the content and dropping unused duplicate pieces.
- **Optimize & Compress Image Streams** compresses pictures so the file does not grow just because it was rebuilt.

Turn them off only when a downstream system has asked for an uncompressed file.

Proof watermark

Apply Production Proof Watermark stamps large, light text across each page. The text box starts as DIGITAL PROOF, in red. Change the words when the shop uses its own proof phrase. Leave the box unchecked for a deliverable file.

Security locks

Print Lock asks viewers not to print. **Edit Lock** asks viewers not to copy or change the file. These are permission flags on the saved PDF. They are a courtesy for proofs. They are not a private vault. Someone determined can still work around a permission flag.

To clear restrictions from a file you are allowed to open, use the Unlock tab. If you created the lock in ReadySetPDF and a blank password is rejected, try the password readysetpdf.

Choose Path & Save writes the file. A merged save says the secured production layout was generated. An individual save says how many files were written and names the folder. A failure names the problem in a Save Failure message.

LOOK AT THE MONITOR FIRST

The picture on the right is the same stopping point the save will use. If the monitor shows an earlier step, the save will stop there too.

24. Job recipes

A job recipe is the Applied Steps stack, saved to a file. It remembers the steps, the unit you were using, and the Page Geometry choice. It is the file Automation asks for.

- 1 Build the stack until the monitor looks right.
- 2 Click Save Recipe. Choose a folder and a name you will recognize later.

- 3 On a new day, load the source files, click Load Recipe, and check the monitor.
- 4 Point an Automation pipeline at that same file if the job should run from a folder.

Mail-merge recipes also remember the template PDF and the spreadsheet path that were current when you added the step. For a hot folder that should accept a new spreadsheet every day, add the merge while the envelope is loaded, save the recipe, and then drop only the new spreadsheet into the input folder.

Load Recipe opens the file you pick. If the file is damaged or is not a recipe, an error explains that it could not be read. Very old recipes that contain only a list of steps still load. The Page Geometry choice stays as it is when an old file does not mention one.

25. Help, updates, and feedback

About

About shows ReadySetPDF, Version 4.0, ReadySetPDF LLC, the website www.readyssetpdf.com, the email darren@readyssetpdf.com, and the copyright line for 2026. The website and the email are buttons.

Hot-fixes

Check for Hot-Fixes is in About and in Global Settings. The status line says Checking for hot-fixes while it looks. If you are current, it says ReadySetPDF 4.0 is up to date. If a newer hot-fix exists, a window shows the version, the notes, and asks whether to download and install it. If you say yes, the status moves through downloading and installing, ReadySetPDF closes, and it opens again on the updated program. If the list cannot be reached, the status says it could not check, and a message explains the problem.

Feedback

Report Bug / Feedback is at the bottom left. The window is titled Submit Feedback. The heading says Help us improve ReadySetPDF. Choose a category: Bug Report, Feature Request, or General Feedback. Add your email if you want a reply. Type the message. **Send Feedback** needs an internet connection. An empty message is refused. A success message thanks you. Please include what you clicked, what you expected, and what the screen said.

Where to look when you are stuck

- Hover the tab. The tooltip is a one-sentence reminder.
- Read the status line on the monitor. It names the step you are viewing.
- Read the footer. It tells you whether you are on a trial, Free, or Pro.
- Gray buttons and starred tabs are the Pro set. The license window is the way through them during a trial that has ended.

26. A few complete walkthroughs

Business cards on a press sheet

- 1 Set the unit to millimeters if the card was designed in millimeters.
- 2 Add the card PDF. Open Page Geometry and confirm the trim.
- 3 Open Grid. Set the sheet to your press size. Set columns and rows. Leave Autoscale off.
- 4 If the PDF already includes bleed, turn that on and type the finished trim. Set the gutter. Zero means the trims touch.
- 5 Leave crop marks on. Set the gap in the same unit.

- 6 Add Grid Imposition. Page through the monitor.
- 7 Build & Save. Leave the proof watermark off if this is the file for the press.

A booklet with creep

- 1 Count the pages. If the count is not a multiple of 4, insert blank pages at the end until it is.
- 2 Open Booklet. Set the sheet, the center gutter, and Creep / sheet to the paper thickness.
- 3 Add Booklet Step. The cover shows zero creep. Page forward.
- 4 Save.

Envelopes from a spreadsheet

- 1 Add the envelope PDF. Open Mail Merge. Browse the spreadsheet.
- 2 Open Address Block, check the four lines and the city line, and click Use This Block.
- 3 Drag the block into place. Preview a few records.
- 4 Add to Stack. Save Recipe if a hot folder will repeat this tomorrow.
- 5 Build & Save.

A preflight gate in front of a hot folder

- 1 On Preflight, choose Commercial Sheetfed, or build your own profile.
- 2 Set the pattern to match the names you will actually produce.
- 3 Turn on Manual execution and Hot-folder watchdog. Choose pass, fail, and maybe folders if you want files sorted.
- 4 Save Recipe on the Preflight tab.
- 5 On Automation, point a pipeline at the input folder, the output folder, and the job recipe.
- 6 Start Hot Folder Watch. Drop a file. The finished PDF lands in the output folder, and the preflight profile runs if the new name matches.

27. Words you will see

Word	Meaning in this program
Trim	The finished size after the cut.
Bleed	Artwork that continues past the trim so a small mis-cut does not show white.
Gutter	The space between copies, or the space at the spine of a booklet.
Creep	The shift caused by paper thickness. Outer sheets stick out farther than inner sheets until the imposition pulls them back.
Imposition	Arranging pages or copies on a press sheet in the order the finishing needs.
Step and repeat	The same artwork, repeated across the sheet.
Sequential	Different pages, filling the sheet in order.
Duplex	A front and a back. Odd pages are fronts. Even pages are backs.
Long edge / short edge	Which side of the sheet the back flips across.
Media, Crop, Trim, Bleed, Art	The named boxes stored in a PDF. Page Geometry reads them.
DPI or PPI	How many pixels of a picture fall into one inch. 300 is a common press minimum.
CMYK	Cyan, magenta, yellow, and black. The usual inks for commercial print.
RGB	Red, green, and blue. The usual colors for a screen.

Word	Meaning in this program
TAC	Total area coverage. How much ink is stacked in one place, as a percent.
Hairline	A stroke thin enough to disappear or break up on press.
Preflight	The check you run before the file is called ready.
Pass, Maybe, Fail	The profile's verdict. Fail means an error. Maybe means only warnings. Pass means neither.
Job recipe	The saved Applied Steps stack.
Preflight recipe	The saved checking profile.
Hot folder	A folder the program watches and processes on its own.
Searchable PDF	A scan that still looks like the scan, with hidden text you can search.

28. If something looks wrong

The preview does not match the tab I have open

Click the matching step in the stack, or add the step. The monitor is allowed to ignore a tab that is not part of the current slice. The status line says so when that happens.

The save is missing the last steps

A selected step is a stopping point. Click the last line in Applied Steps, then save again.

Sizes jumped when I changed units

The digits in most boxes stay put, and they are read in the new unit. Set the unit first. Mail-merge positions do convert. Page Geometry's readout follows the unit on purpose.

Grid is scaling my card

Turn Autoscale off. With it on, the card fills the cell. With it off, a 106 mm card stays 106 mm, and white space only changes the gap around it.

Bleed looks like extra gutter

Turn on PDF already includes bleed and type the finished trim. Gutter 0 then means the trims touch. The bleed hangs into the gutter instead of being treated as part of the piece.

Booklet creep is invisible

You are on the cover. Page forward. Creep on the cover is zero by design.

The page count is not divisible by 4

Use Insert Blank Page until the count is a multiple of 4, and keep those blank steps above the booklet step.

Mail merge preview is blank or the type vanished

Auto-shrink should keep a long line inside a small box. If the box height is still tiny, select the field and increase H. An address block grows itself when you click Use This Block, but a hand-placed column uses the height on the style row.

Only one file was added

The footer is on Free. Free keeps a single file. Activate a license or wait if you are still inside the 30-day trial and the footer has not caught up. Use Activate / check license.

A Pro tab does nothing except open a window

That window is the license window. The trial has ended, or this computer has no Pro license yet.

Preflight says no file matches

The pattern is narrower than your file names. Standard Digital Press uses *.pdf. Commercial Sheetfed uses *_print.pdf. Soft Proof uses *PROOF*.pdf. Change the pattern or rename the file.

Preflight did not move the file or write JSON

Those boxes are Pro actions, and the folders have to be filled in. Move original file has to be checked. On Free, the routing section of the report says those actions are part of Pro.

The hot folder ignored my spreadsheet

The job recipe needs a mail-merge step that was saved while the envelope was loaded. Add the merge to the stack, save the recipe again, and drop the CSV, XLSX, or ODS file.

OCR says the engine was not found

The Tesseract program is missing. Install it, or ask the person who maintains the computer, then start the hot folders again.

I cleared the files and the steps disappeared

Clear in Assets Manager also resets the stack. Save Recipe first next time. Reset on the stack clears steps and leaves the files.

The proof still says DIGITAL PROOF

Uncheck Apply Production Proof Watermark before you save the deliverable, or change the words if you wanted a different stamp.

This manual covers ReadySetPDF 4.0 as it appears on screen: every tab, the three side panels, settings, export, both kinds of recipe, and the hot folders. When the program and this book disagree, the screen you have in front of you is the one to follow, and a note through Report Bug / Feedback is the way to tell ReadySetPDF LLC.

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